Pakistan studies



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Chapter 4



Society And Culture Of Pakistan

The people of Pakistan

- **Pakistani culture** is a mixed **culture**. Although, majority of people are Muslims by birth and faith yet there is great influence of Hindu and British **culture.** The country's **culture** has been shaped by the interaction between different religions. Explains that **Pakistani culture** is a beautiful mixtuer of Punjabi, sindhi and pathan **cultures**.
- The social structure in Pakistani society. Specifically, a woman is expected to take care of the home as wife and mother, whereas the male dominates outside the home as a breadwinner. In Pakistan, women have held high offices including that of the Prime Minister, Speaker of the National Assembly, Leader of the Opposition, as well as federal ministers.

Education

- plays an import role in the progress and development of a state. Progress of any country depends upon its literacy rate and quality of education in that country. Therefore, it is the key priorities of nations. The Pakistani education system is one of the oldest in the world. They boast of having one of the most extensive and effective curricula in all of Asia.
- The education system in Pakistan is generally divided into six levels: preschool (for the age from 3 to 5 years), primary (years one to five), middle (years six to eight), high (year's nine and ten, leading to the Secondary School Certificate or SSC), intermediate (years eleven and twelve, leading to a Higher Secondary. *Education in Pakistan* is free and compulsory for all children between the ages of five and 16, or up through grade 10. If we look towards higher education system, there are hundreds of private and government colleges and universities. These are of different categories, for example universities of engineering and technology, medical science, business, information technology, agriculture, survey and micro technology and other fields of life.

Population density

- The current population of **Pakistan** is **231,965,962** as of Thursday, February 2, 2023, based on World meter elaboration of the latest United Nations data.
- Pakistan ranks number 5 in the list of countries (and dependencies) by population. The **population density** in Pakistan is **287 per square Km**

Pakistan society and culture

- **1. Society**
- **The concept of society:** A community, nation, or broad grouping of people having common traditions, institutions, and collective activities and interests, and a body of individuals living as members of a community. **The people who interact in such a way as to share a common culture**. The cultural bond may be ethnic or cultural, based on gender, or due to shared beliefs, values, and activities is called society.
- **Approaches to the study of society: Sociology** is a social science that focuses on society, human social behavior, patterns of social relationships, social interaction, and feature of culture associated with everyday life. But sociologists intentionally use the **scientific method** to maintain as much jutice, focus, and consistency as possible in collecting and analyzing data in research studies. With its systematic approach, the scientific method has show useful in shaping sociological studies.

- If the human behaviors around those claims were tested systematically, a student could write a report and offer the findings to fellow sociologists and the world in general. The new point of view could help people understand themselves and their neighbors and help people make better decisions about their lives. It might seem strange to use scientific practices to study social trends, but, as we shall see, it's extremely helpful to depend on systematic approaches that research methods provide. Sociologists often begin the research process by asking a question about how or why things happen in this world. It might be a unique question about a new trend or an old question about a common aspect of life. Once a question is formed, a sociologist proceeds through an in-depth process to answer it. In deciding how to design that process, the researcher may adopt a **positivist approach** or an informative approach.

Basic pattern and levels of social organization

- In Sociology, a social organization is a pattern of relationships between and among individuals and social groups. Aspects of social organization are presented in all social situations where a few or more people are thrown into a set of related activities arising from the operation of social standard; the main definition of social organization given by various sociologists is given below:

- **Ougburn and Nimkoff** defined organization as an expression of different parts which perform various functions; it is an active group device for getting something done".

- **Duncan Mitchell** explained social organization as, "the interconnection of parts, which is an essential characteristic of all collective structure: groups, communities and societies".

- **H.M Johnson defined**, "organization refers to a feature of interaction systems".

The individual and social organization.

- Individuals cannot hold beliefs or perform actions apart from against the background of particular social structures. And social structures only influence, as against to control or deciding, the beliefs and decisions of individuals, so social structures can arise only out of performances by individuals. The grammar of our concepts shows it is a mistake to suggest a moment of origin when anyone individuals or social structures must have predated to the other. Our concepts of an individual and a social structure are unclear, and this allows for their existence being dependent on one another. Individuals cannot have pure observations; they necessarily construe their observations in terms of a previous set of theories, so they cannot reach beliefs through observations except in the context of a previous set of theories. Individuals reach the beliefs they do through their experiences, but they cannot have experiences except in a theoretical conditions, so they cannot come to hold the beliefs they do except against the background of a theoretical context.

Culture
The concept of culture

- Culture consists in shape ways of thinking, feeling and reacting, obtain and transfer mainly by symbols, comprised the distinctive achievements of human groups, including their The Concept of Culture 11 expression in antique; the essential central of culture consists of traditional (historically obtain and selected) ideas and especially their attached values.

The concept of culture

- Every great nation enjoys its own culture. Similarly, Pakistani culture is very distinct due to its Islamic nature and rich historical background. Pakistani culture has the following characteristics: 1- Islamic values and traditions. ii- National and regional languages. iii- Mixed culture. iv- Rich literature v- Male dominated society. vi- Variety of Dresses vii- Fairs and Festivals. viii- Sports ix- Handicrafts. i- Islamic Values: Pakistani culture is actually a part of the current Islamic civilization which produce its value and traditions from Islam and rich Islamic history. Majority of population comprises of Muslims and follows teachings of Islam, belief in one Allah, Prophet Hood of Hazrat Muhammad P.B.U.H, brotherhood, equality and social justice etc. Islam is religion of peace and patience. Pakistani society is very cooperative. National calendar is marked by religious days which are observed with great devotion.

Mixed Culture

- Practically speaking Pakistani culture is a beautiful combine of the Punjabi, Sindhi, Pathan, Baluchi, Barohi, Seraiki and Kashmiri cultures. In addition, the presence of Hindu community in Sindh gives touches of dance and music in the Sindhi region.
- **Variety of Dresses:** Pakistani culture is rich in variety of dresses: The people of Punjab, the Pathans of NWFP, the Baluchi people and the Sindhi wear their own distinct dresses. These dresses are very colorful and prominent and give attractive look during national fairs and festivals.

Pakistan Languages and Literature

- **Languages of Pakistan**; Punjabi (38.78%); Pashto (18.24%); Sindhi (14.57%); Saraiki (12.19%); Urdu (7.08%); Balochi (3.02%); Hindko (2.24%); others (6.25%) are spoken in the Pakistan. Urdu and English are official languages, but Punjabi, Sindhi, Pashto, Balochi, Hindko, and Brahui are also spoken; English is common among the upper classes and in the government. Most of Pakistani can understand and speak Urdu but Urdu is the first language of only eight percent of the population. More people speak Punjabi, Sindhi, Pashto and Saraiki. A great many Arabic, Persian and English words have been comprised into Pakistan's languages. Urdu is the national language and the language of most print media.

Pakistan Languages and Literature

- English has official status and often is regarded as the language of the upper class. Urdu and English often are used in government and business. Punjabi is the most common language, followed by Pashto, Sindhi, Siraiki, Urdu and Balochi. Smaller linguistic groups include the Hindko in Khyber Pakhtunkhwa (formerly North-West Frontier Province), the Farsi-speaking Hazaras of Balochistan, and the Brahuis in Sindh and Balochistan.

Relationship between society and culture

- A culture represents the beliefs and practices of a group, while society represents the people who share those beliefs and practices. Neither society nor culture could exist without the other. Pakistan has a collectivist culture in the sense that **people are deeply interdependent and loyal to those who are in their inner circle**. Social connections are essential to daily life, as citizens have often had to depend on themselves instead of their government for support and opportunities. Different societies have different cultures; a culture represents the beliefs and practices of a group, while society represents the people who share those beliefs and practices. Similarly, both cultures and societies often have their own gender roles, kinship organizations, shared norms, values, and traditions. Social theory and cultural theory overlap quite a lot.

Relationship between society and culture

- In terms of definitions, social theory is a sort of framework for analyzing how societies form and social practices of a culture. although cultural theory examines cultural action and a culture's relationships to other cultures, nature and more. If you're studying anthropology(population analysis), social and cultural theory would be studied as both separate theories and also how they, in turn, impact one another. the culture is something that identify every human being from their Society so in particular the relationship of culture and society in anthropology is how human use culture to behave and interact and to adopt with their society for a longer period of time.

Pakistani Society

- **Social institution: Family, school, religion, media**

In traditional parts of Pakistan, social organization go round relationship rather than around the caste system that is used in India. **The baradari (literally "brotherhood") is the most important social institution**. **The family** is generally consider as a primary social institution. The institution of family is a basic unit in the society, and the many sides functions performed by it makes it a much-needed institution in a society. It is one of the oldest social institutions on the earth. Although families differ widely around the world, they also share certain common concerns in their everyday lives.

Pakistani Society

- A formal process of knowledge in which some people carefully teach while adopt others social role of learner. Education refers to the contributions of the school to the development and maintenance of education at the different levels of society, i.e. School, college and universities.
- **Religion** is an agent of socialization. • Religion promotes welfare. • Religion is play social control. • Religion is influences economy. • Religion provides mental peace • Religion gives man comfort, strength and hope in times of crisis and desperation.

Pakistani Culture

- Pakistani Culture is very unique in terms of its **social values go around the religion of Islam**. The region has formed a distinct cultural unit within the main cultural complex of South Asia, Middle East and Central Asia with an combination of elements from various capture cultures from the earliest of times.
- There are five culture**, Asian culture, American culture, Arabian culture, Chinese culture, African culture** are some of the main cultures around the world.
- **Similarities and differences in the main culture of Pakistan (Punjab, the kpk, Sindh, and Baluchistan)**
- It comprises four provinces, and each province has its lifestyle. Different languages are spoken in different provinces, e.g. **People of Punjab speak Punjabi, people of Sindh speak Sindhi, people of Baluchistan speak Balochi, Pashto, Urdu, and Brahui, people of Khyber-Pakhtunkhwa speaks Pashto, and English**. The dress, religious and food almost same in all provinces.

Pakistani Culture

- Civil society of Pakistan, The Provinces of Sindh, Punjab, Baluchistan and Khyber Pakhtunkhwa do not have similarity roots and cultural background and each province has distinctive language, ethnicity and culture, and its cause the cultural different in Pakistan. The goal of the study is to look into the cultural capacity of these four provinces of Pakistan. The Greet values survey module (2013) has been used as an instrument in this research. The data of 632 participants were utilized in this research for final investigation. The results verify the significant difference among cultural capacity of four provinces of Pakistan.

Modernization and its impact on society

- The process of starting to use the most recent methods, ideas, equipment, etc. so that something becomes or seems more modern: Modernization refers *to a model of an developmental transition from a 'pre-modern' or 'traditional' to a 'modern' society*. The term ‘modernization’ despite its recent popularity is fully misunderstand and needs clarification. Firstly, modernization is not opposed to traditionalism. A modern society is not fully separation from traditionalism nor can a traditional society exist without modern element.

Modernization and its impact on society

- Secondly, scholars in Economics, Sociology, Political Science, and Psychology have studied the concept of modernization in their own way causing more confusion and disparity in approach. Thirdly, industrialization and urbanization are not essential precondition to modernization. Japan is highly industrialized without being modern. Punjab is urbanized without industrialization. In several African countries, industrialization followed modernization.

Ethnicity

- Pakistan has numerous large ethnic groups, including the Punjabis, Pashtuns, and Sindhi. Smaller groups include the Saraikis, Muhajirs, and Balochis. Learn about their cultural, religious, and social practices.

- **Pakistan** is located in southern Asia, and is surrounded by India, Iran, Afghanistan, and China. The country is made up of many different ethnic groups, with **Punjabi** being the largest group, at 44% of the country's population in 2009. The next largest groups are the **Pashtuns**, making up 15% of the population, and **Sindhi**, which make up 14% of the total population. The smaller groups include the **Saraikis**, **Muhajirs**, and **Balochis**, which make up 8%, 8%, and 4% respectively. Muslim is the official religion of Pakistan, with approximately 96% of the population practicing it as of 2010. Other religions, such as Christianity and Hindu, are practiced by the remaining 4% of the population.